

NICK SHAW

Head of QA and Delivery: SaaS, Enterprise, Public Sector

Belfast, UK | Remote

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Head of QA and Delivery with 12 years' experience leading teams of up to 25 across SaaS, enterprise, public sector and healthcare environments. Proven in QA strategy, Playwright automation and regulated programme delivery, with a track record of measurable improvement in coverage, release cadence and production stability. Cross-functional leader with Scrum Master and Product Owner experience across Agile and Waterfall programmes, hands-on in AI-assisted testing using Claude Code, Playwright MCP and LLM evaluation.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- QA Strategy, Governance and Test Lifecycle Leadership
- Test Automation and Quality Engineering (Playwright, BDD, CI/CD Integration)
- AI-Assisted Development and Testing (Claude Code, Playwright MCP, LLM Evaluation)
- Multi-Team Leadership, Resourcing and Delivery Management
- Agile Delivery and Product Leadership (Scrum Master, Product Owner)
- Risk-Based Testing, Defect Management and Regulatory Compliance
- Performance, API, Integration and Data Validation
- Executive and Stakeholder Engagement and C-Suite Reporting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of QA (Promoted from Lead QA)

Mar 2025 – Dec 2025

Cloudbooking | London, UK (Remote)

Directed QA strategy, delivery operations and performance across a 17-person SaaS team spanning web, mobile and tablet platforms on cloud-native applications hosted on AWS. Member of the senior management team, collaborating with the C-suite on product and programme strategy.

- Doubled test coverage from 45% to 90% within six months through structured test case development, AI-assisted test generation, shift-left practices and embedding QA in backlog refinement
- Reduced manual regression effort by 50% through targeted automation and tightened sprint scope
- Overhauled the organisation's Agile delivery approach, improving release cadence from monthly to twice-monthly
- Architected Playwright automation frameworks (JavaScript/TypeScript) for critical end-to-end workflows using AI-assisted development, establishing scalable automated regression capability
- Managed test delivery across cloud-native SaaS applications hosted on Azure/AWS.
- Implemented accessibility-first delivery (WCAG 2.1), embedding standards into sprint execution and supporting team adoption

Operated across the full delivery lifecycle, bridging QA, product ownership and programme governance within a fast-moving SaaS environment. Managed all aspects of team leadership including resourcing, hiring and performance, while maintaining active Scrum Master and Product Owner responsibilities across the roadmap.

Tools: Axe DevTools, Azure DevOps, Claude Code, Google Lighthouse, Jira, Miro, NVDA, OWASP ZAP, Playwright (JavaScript, TypeScript), Postman, Qase, SQL, Swagger, TestRail, WAV

Test Manager

Jun 2021 – Dec 2024

ITS Computing Ltd | Belfast, UK (Remote)

Led QA and delivery across a 25-person distributed team spanning the UK and India, owning QA strategy, delivery governance and test lifecycle execution for major national public sector programmes within complex regulatory environments.

- Delivered end-to-end QA strategy and full test lifecycle for national public sector programmes including LPS Rates and Benefits, Insolvency Service GB, NISRA, PBNI and FSNI
- Built and scaled test automation capability from scratch, implementing Playwright and TestComplete while increasing regression coverage across all programmes
- Standardised QA processes and governance frameworks across concurrent Agile and Waterfall programmes, establishing consistent quality standards across all active public sector accounts
- Contributed QA strategy, technical input and risk mitigation to public sector bid and tender submissions
- Implemented accessibility-first practices (WCAG 2.1), embedding accessibility standards and delivering team training

Maintained Product Owner and Scrum Master responsibilities across concurrent Agile and Waterfall programmes, with additional scope covering performance testing, UAT, change control and pre-release validation across all active programmes.

Tools: Axe DevTools, Azure DevOps, JMeter, Jira, Miro, NVDA, Playwright (JavaScript), Postman, SQL, Swagger, TestComplete, WAV

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior QA Engineer

Mar 2019 – Jun 2021

HHA Exchange | Belfast, UK

- BDD automation (SpecFlow/Gherkin), API and end-to-end testing on a large-scale US healthcare SaaS platform (.NET, Angular) within a regulated, distributed environment
- Supported sprint planning, backlog refinement and UAT across Agile delivery cycles

QA Engineer

Sept 2017 – Mar 2019

Flowlens | Belfast, UK

- Functional and integration testing across SaaS modules built on Ruby on Rails, including Xero and QuickBooks integrations
- Produced test documentation and onboarding materials to improve knowledge transfer and support issue resolution

UK QA Lead (Promoted from Intern through to Senior QA)

Nov 2013 – Nov 2016

Concentrix | Belfast, UK

- Managed a 10-person QA team across .NET CRM SaaS platforms for enterprise clients including Riverbed, Polycom, Symantec and Acronis
- Owned end-to-end QA strategy, SDLC governance and defect management, with on-site stakeholder delivery in Boston, New York and San Francisco

PROJECTS

nickshawqa.com | QA Knowledge Base & Portfolio

Nov 2024 – present

A production site built in React and TypeScript using Claude Code, using Playwright MCP for visual verification and sanity testing throughout. Houses a 105+ article QA knowledge base across 13 structured topic areas, covering the full testing landscape from foundations and manual techniques through to Playwright automation, AI-generated tests, MCP-assisted test execution and LLM evaluation. A portfolio of 15+ projects including:

- Live 3D global earthquake tracker powered by USGS real-time GeoJSON feed
- Live ISS tracker with a custom GLSL atmospheric shader
- Polyphonic synthesiser built on the Web Audio API
- Playwright test suite and a wider collection of React and TypeScript exercises

A self-directed, end-to-end demonstration of technical range, applied AI-assisted development and sustained independent delivery.

asaware.org | Axial SpA Awareness Project

Jan 2026 – present

An informational site raising awareness of Ankylosing Spondylitis, developed in React, TypeScript and Vite. Encompasses independent front-end delivery including hosting, CI/CD and ongoing maintenance.

QUALIFICATIONS AND CERTIFICATIONS

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| • Certified Scrum Master (CSM) | 2025 |
| • Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) | 2025 |
| • ISTQB Foundation Certificate | 2013 |

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

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| • Claude Code in Action (Anthropic) | 2026 |
| • Introduction to Agent Skills (Anthropic) | 2026 |
| • Claude 101 (Anthropic) | 2026 |

EDUCATION

Queen's University, Belfast

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|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| • MA Creative Writing: Merit | 2012 – 2013 |
| • BA (Hons) English: 2:1 | 2007 – 2010 |

ADDITIONAL ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Selected for the BBC Voices Scriptwriting Programme (2026), a highly competitive national scheme for emerging writers
- Authored sketches and plays performed at Grand Opera House, Lyric Theatre and MAC Theatre; commissioned by Tinderbox Theatre Company